

S&P Global Flash France PMI®

French private sector activity rebounds in September and rises at fastest pace in over two years

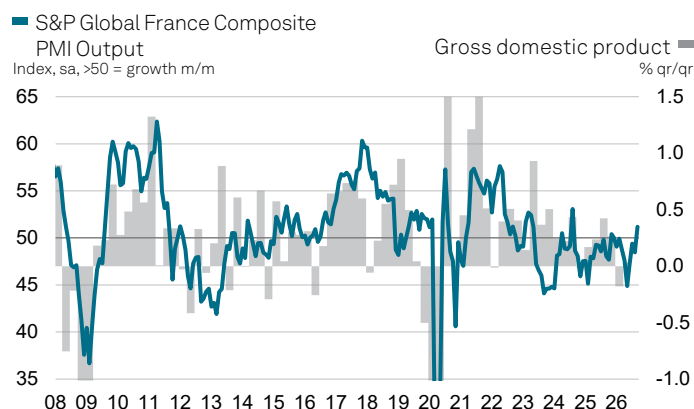
September 2026

Flash France PMI Composite Output Index: 51.2 (Aug: 48.5). 25-month high.

Flash France Services PMI Business Activity Index: 51.4 (Aug: 48.0). 10-month high.

Flash France Manufacturing Output Index: 50.2 (Aug: 50.7). 2-month low.

Flash France Manufacturing PMI: 50.3 (Aug: 51.1). 2-month low.



Data were collected 10-21 September 2026.

Sources: S&P Global PMI, INSEE via S&P Global Market Intelligence. © 2026 S&P Global

The September flash PMI® report for France revealed a strengthening of the eurozone's second-biggest economy at the end of the third quarter as activity growth returned. Moreover, the expansion was the quickest in just over two years. Demand improved, reflecting rising sales activity in the service sector, although employment continued to decline and business optimism weakened further. Survey data on prices meanwhile signalled marked increases, with rates of input cost and output charge inflation at their steepest since May.

The headline S&P Global Flash France Composite Output Index – which is based on approximately 80-90% of total survey responses and intended to give an early indication of the final figures – rose above the 50.0 no-change threshold in September to 51.2, from 48.5 in August. In doing so, the headline measure signalled a renewed expansion in private sector business activity, ending the spell of contraction that commenced at the beginning of the year. The rate of growth signalled was the strongest since August 2024. While increases in output were recorded at the sector level, much of the impetus came from services as manufacturing production growth slowed and was again only marginal.

September 'flash' data indicated a mild recovery in demand. New orders rose marginally, marking the first improvement in ten months. Exports became less of a drag on overall sales performance, as evidenced by the softest contraction in new foreign business in the year-to-date.

Although only mild, September's rise in new orders spurred backlog accumulation, anecdotal evidence suggested. Outstanding business volumes increased at the quickest pace in almost three-and-a-half years. French companies refrained from expanding their staffing capacities, however,

Comment

Joe Hayes, Senior Principal Economist at S&P Global Market Intelligence:

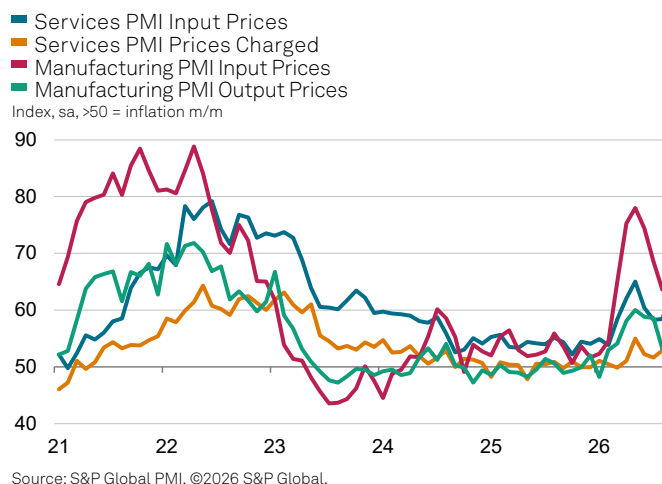
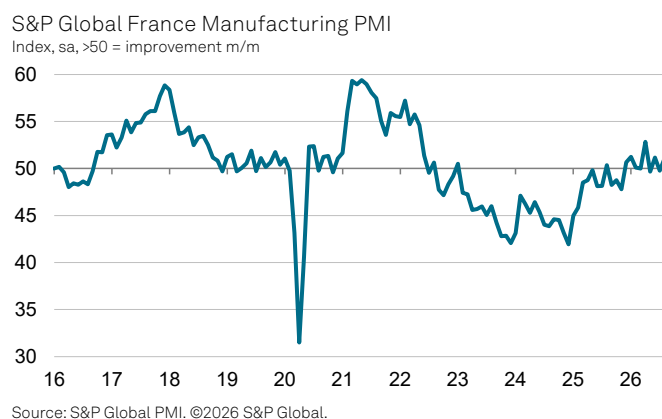
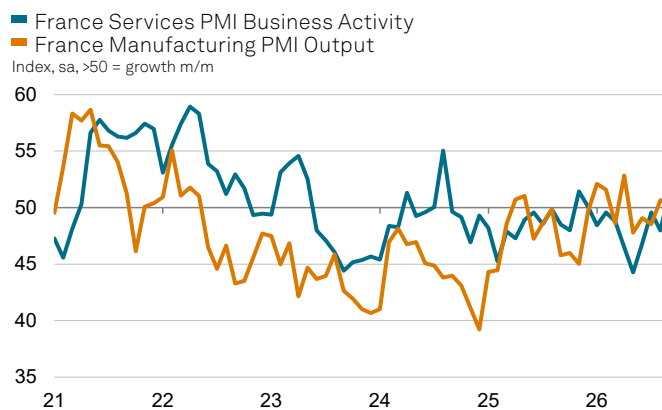
"The French economy displayed surprising resilience in September, although the durability of this expansion is questionable given new orders barely rose and firms' own expectations for activity deteriorated. There may also be some payback driving the uplift after the extreme heat seen in August disrupted some business activities, particularly in the service sector.

"Nevertheless, these data reinforce the narrative that European economies are weathering the war-induced inflation shock well. The pick-up in the PMI price measures seen in September should however be watched closely, particularly as we approach the winter months, as the risk of energy price inflation spreading to other areas of the economy undoubtedly rises."

as private sector employment decreased modestly and for a fifth successive month. Qualitative responses highlighted a mix of contributing factors such as redundancies, resignations and non-renewal of temporary contracts.

Although activity and demand trends were positive during September, business expectations continued to deteriorate. Overall, surveyed companies in France were their least optimistic towards the 12-month outlook for output since May. Higher interest rates, political uncertainty and international competition were reasons cited for lower confidence.

Inflation across France's private sector accelerated sharply at the end of the third quarter. Input and output prices both rose at quicker rates for the first time since May as rising cost pressures were passed on to clients via charge uplifts. Fuel price increases were frequently mentioned by panel members as a driving force of inflation, as well as component prices, energy and metals.



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Methodology

Final September data are published on 1 October for manufacturing and 5 October for services and composite indicators.

The S&P Global Flash France Composite PMI® is compiled by S&P Global from responses to questionnaires sent to survey panels of around 400 manufacturers and 400 service providers. The panels are each stratified by detailed sector and company workforce size, based on contributions to GDP. The services sector is defined as consumer (excluding retail), transport, information, communication, finance, insurance, real estate and business services.

Survey responses are collected in the second half of each month and indicate the direction of change compared to the previous month. The following variables are monitored:

Manufacturing: Output, new orders, new export orders, backlogs of work, stocks of finished goods, employment, quantity of purchases, suppliers' delivery times, stocks of purchases, input prices, output prices, future output.

Services: Business activity, new business, new export business, outstanding business, employment, input prices, prices charged, future activity.

A diffusion index is calculated for each manufacturing and services variable. The index is the sum of the percentage of 'higher' responses and half the percentage of 'unchanged' responses. The indices vary between 0 and 100, with a reading above 50 indicating an overall increase compared to the previous month, and below 50 an overall decrease. The indices are then seasonally adjusted.

Composite indices for are calculated by weighting together comparable manufacturing and services indices using official manufacturing and services annual value added.

The headline figure is the Composite Output Index. This is a weighted average of the Manufacturing Output Index and the Services Business Activity Index. It may be referred to as the 'Composite PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI, which is a weighted average of five manufacturing indices (including the Manufacturing Output Index).

The headline manufacturing figure is the Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index™ (PMI®). The PMI is a weighted average of the following five indices: New Orders (30%), Output (25%), Employment (20%), Suppliers' Delivery Times (15%) and Stocks of Purchases (10%). For the PMI calculation the Suppliers' Delivery Times Index is inverted so that it moves in a comparable direction to the other indices.

The headline services figure is the Services Business Activity Index. This is a diffusion index calculated from a single question that asks for changes in the volume of business activity compared with one month previously. The Business Activity Index is comparable to the Manufacturing Output Index. It may be referred to as the 'Services PMI' but is not comparable with the headline Manufacturing PMI.

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Flash data are calculated from around 80-90% of total responses and are intended to provide an accurate early indication of the final data. Since flash data were first processed, the average differences between final and flash index values for the headline indices are:

Composite Output Index = 0.0 (absolute difference 0.4)

Services Business Activity Index = -0.1 (absolute difference 0.5)

Manufacturing PMI = 0.1 (absolute difference 0.3)

S&P Global do not revise underlying survey data after first publication, but seasonal adjustment factors may be revised from time to time as appropriate which will affect the seasonally adjusted data series. Historical data relating to the underlying (unadjusted) numbers, first published seasonally adjusted series and subsequently revised data are available to subscribers from S&P Global.

For further information on the PMI survey methodology, please contact economics@spglobal.com.

S&P Global

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